



Creating a bootable CD

We help you create a bootable CD-ROM using Nero Express

A bootable medium is a life-saver. Sooner or later something will go wrong with your computer and you will need a boot disc to rescue it.

Current computers can boot off a CD-ROM or a DVD-ROM disc. The benefits of using an optical disc, as opposed to the traditional floppy, are twofold. The major benefit is that of reduction of data

create bad sectors on a floppy. A CD medium is free of such hassles.

Of course a CD is not without its drawbacks—the biggest concern being that of scratches across its readable face.

The other advantage is that of the storage space offered. A bootable CD should also carry backup and restore software along with an antivirus solution,

1 Create A Boot Image

You will first need to create a bootable floppy the old way. To do this in Microsoft Windows XP, insert a new floppy in your drive; head to 'My Computer' and right-click the floppy drive icon. Select 'Format' from the menu and select 'Create an MS-DOS startup disk' and then click on 'Start'.

2 Using Nero Express

In order to create the bootable disk, we will use Nero 6 Express.

Start the application and from the Nero Express menu and select the 'Bootable data disc' option under the 'Data' menu.

3 Adding Files To Your Bootable

If you need to add any files or applications to your bootable disc, the next window is where you should do so. If you do not wish to add any files, you can skip this option and move to the next step by clicking on the 'Next' button.

4 Pointing Out The Boot Image

The next step is to point Nero to the bootable 'image' file. To use the floppy click on the 'Read boot disc in drive' radio button and select your floppy drive. If you have your own image (IMA) file, point Nero to it. Now, click on Next.

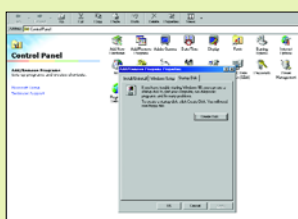
5 Burning Your Bootable Disc

This final step requires that you select your CD-Writer, then name your bootable disc.

Click on the 'Burn' button and be patient as your bootable disc is burnt.



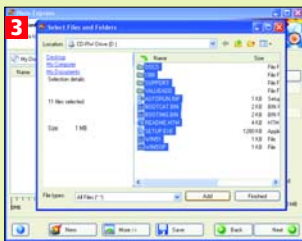
Create a bootable floppy disk—this will form a boot image



Creating a bootable floppy under Windows 98



Start Nero Express to create a bootable CD-ROM



You can add files other than the boot image to your CD-ROM



Choosing the boot image, created earlier on the floppy



The final step: a bootable CD-ROM is minutes away

corruption. An optical disc by virtue of its design is immune to stray magnetic fields which are so common around a personal computer. Such fields would lead to frequent data corruption and

a program to partition your hard disk, maybe even an image of your desktop. This article will tell you how to create a bootable CD-ROM using a popular application called Nero Express 6.

If you are using Windows 98, go to 'Add / Remove Programs', found in the 'Control Panel' and select the 'Startup Disk' tab. Now insert a blank floppy disk and click 'Create Disk' button.



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